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A guide to using Edits,
Meta's CapCut rival for
short-form video editing

Meta recently [released a new video editing app](#) for creators called Edits. The new app is designed to rival ByteDance's CapCut, a popular short-form video-editing app used by many creators.

Meta first shared that it was working on Edits back in January after ByteDance-owned CapCut was removed from U.S. app stores when the TikTok ban momentarily went into effect. Although the app has since come back online and is available to download, TikTok's future in the U.S. remains uncertain, so Meta is ready to capitalize on CapCut's possible absence in the future with its new Edits app.

IMAGE CREDITS: META

We've created this guide to walk you through the app and the different features it offers, and we provide an overview of how it compares to CapCut.

How to get started with the app



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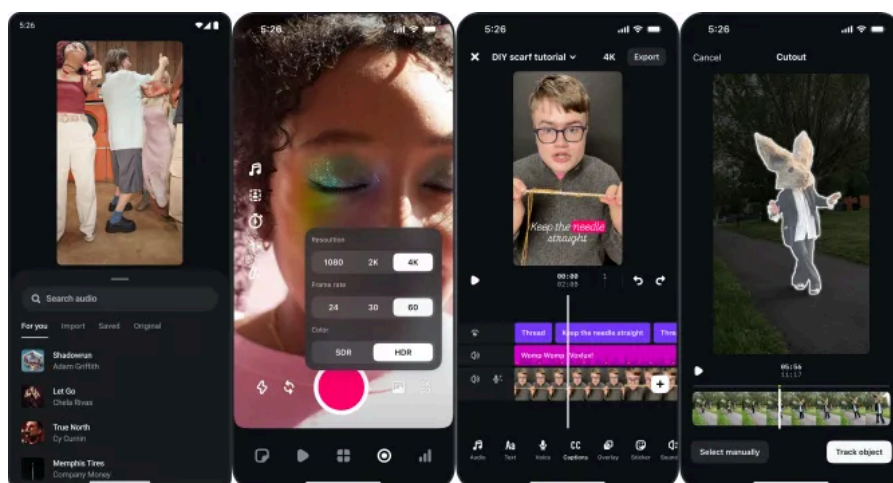
Edits is available to download on both [iOS](#) and [Android](#). Once you download the app and open it, you will be asked to log in with your Instagram account.

From there you will see five main tabs: Ideas, Inspiration, Projects, Record, and Insights. The Ideas tab offers creators a space to jot down ideas for new videos and save reels to a collection, and the Inspiration tab features a hub for discovering trending audios and other popular reels.

The Projects tab is where creators can store and revisit the videos they currently have in progress. This tab is also where creators can upload videos from their phone's camera roll. The Record tab lets creators start filming video content right within Edits. Lastly, the Insights tab gives creators an overview of how their content is performing by surfacing metrics like views, reach, and follower counts.

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Tools and features available on Edits



Green screen: Replace and edit the background of your videos with one tap.



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Timeline: Precisely arrange and adjust clips.

Captions: Add automatic captions to your videos in multiple languages.

Audio library: Add music from Instagram's library to your videos.

Cutouts: Isolate specific objects with precision tracking.

Animate: Turn static images into videos using AI.

Apply all: Apply filters, effects, transitions, and adjustments to all of your clips at once.

Timeline frame rate selector: Convert your video to the frame rate you want in order to enhance playback smoothness.

Alignment guides: Ensure viewers can see the important parts of your video when posted and accurately position text, emoji, or other elements.

Beat markers: Add auto-detected beat markers to help you align clips, text, and overlays with audio when editing.

Filters: Choose from 30 different filter options to add a unique look to your videos.

Transitions: Choose from 30 different transitions to connect different video clips in a seamless way.

Teleprompter: Follow your written script while recording.

Restyle: Use AI to change the look and style of your video with a library of presets.

Keyframes: Animate the position, rotation, and scale of clips.

Cut Silences: Automatically remove unwanted silence from reels.

Import Audio from Files: Add your own unique sounds directly into edits.

Clip Preview: Preview clips while you're recording from the camera.

How does Edits differ from CapCut?

While both Edits and CapCut are great options for editing short-form videos, there are some differences between the two services.

CapCut offers more robust editing options, including AI features, than Edits does. Of course, this can be expected since Edits is a lot newer than CapCut. Meta will likely continue to build out Edits over the next months and years, so we can expect to see more advanced functionality in the future.

It's also worth noting that CapCut has a more extensive music library compared to Edits.

Another difference is the fact that Edits currently doesn't have a subscription offering (for now), but CapCut does. While CapCut offers a free version, some of its advanced tools are locked behind a paid subscription. Edits is free to use, but this will likely change in the future, as Instagram head [Adam Mosseri has stated](#) that later versions of Edits may include paid features.

In addition, while CapCut is available on the web, Edits is mobile-only. However, this could change in the future.

Update: This story originally ran in May and is updated regularly with new information.

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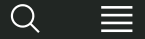
Aisha Malik

Consumer News Reporter |

Aisha is a consumer news reporter at TechCrunch. Prior to joining the publication in 2021, she was a telecom reporte...

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Ivan Mehta — 11:29 AM PST · January 19, 2025

Meta Sunday announced a new video editing app called Edits, after ByteDance's video editing app CapCut was [removed from Apple's App Store](#) and the Google Play Store as part of [the TikTok ban](#).

Instagram head Adam Mosseri (pictured above) [said on Threads](#) that the app will launch next month on iOS, with an Android version following later. He added that the company is working with select creators to gather feedback about the app.

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“Today we’re announcing a new app called ‘Edits,’ for those of you who are passionate about making videos on your phone. There’s a lot going on right

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now, but no matter what happens, it's our job to provide the best possible tools for creators," he wrote.

Mosseri said the app will have a suite of creative tools, including a dedicated tab for inspiration, a tab for keeping track of ideas, and a high-quality camera. Plus, it will have the ability to share draft versions of creations with friends or collaborators. He added that creators would be able to see insights on how videos made through Edits are performing on Instagram after publishing.

In a separate post, he emphasized that the app is "more for creators than casual video makers," which is hard to quantify in measurable terms.

Meta has historically made moves to fill in gaps in the market. When TikTok was banned in India in June 2020, it launched a similar product, [Instagram Reels, days later in early July](#). In 2023, the company also launched Threads, [a rival to text-based social networks such as X](#). The company likely realizes that a lot of video creators will try another tool in the absence of CapCut. And even if the app is restored, the uncertainty will create opportunities for other tools.

Earlier this month, a16z-backed video editing app [Captions switched to a freemium model to attract more users](#) and challenge CapCut.

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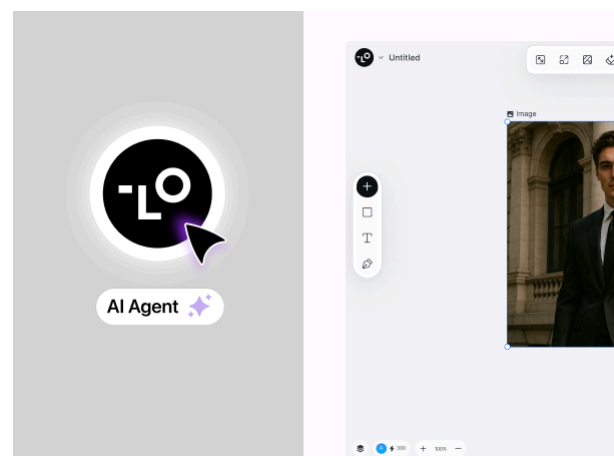
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Ivan Mehta

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Ivan covers global consumer tech developments at TechCrunch. He is based out of India and has previously...

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Meta releases its CapCut rival Edits globally

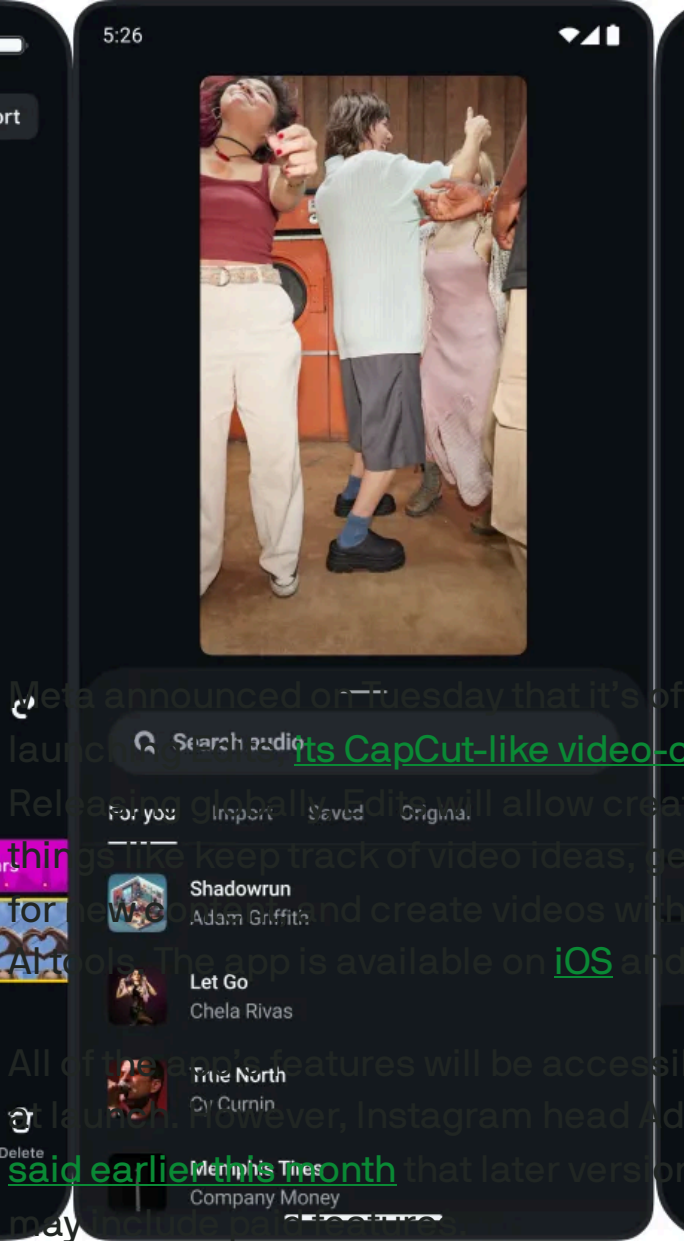


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The launch of the new app also allows Meta and Instagram to push creators of all kinds to use Edits as opposed to CapCut for all of their short-form

Aisha Malik — 9:30 AM PDT · April 22, 2025

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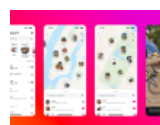
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content. In its announcement post, Instagram notes that Edits is designed to help creators make videos not just for Instagram or Facebook, but also for “any platform,” which is likely a reference to competitors like TikTok and YouTube Shorts.

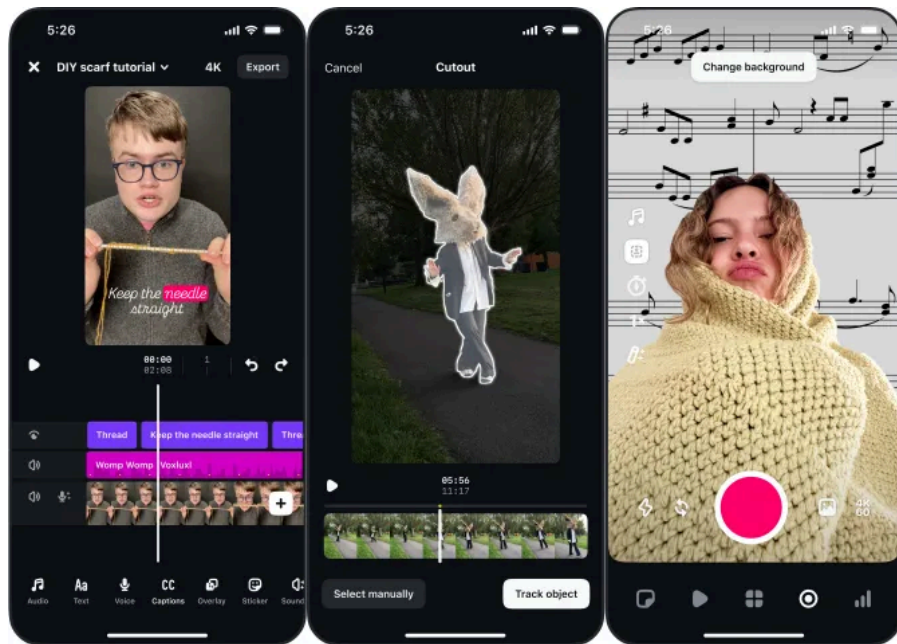


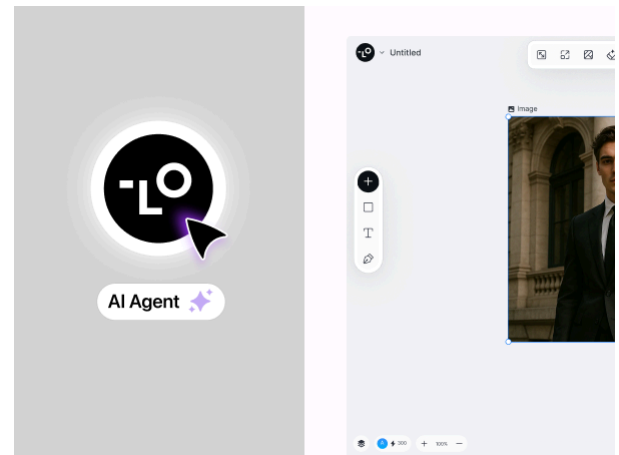
IMAGE CREDITS: META

It’s worth noting that one major difference between Edits and CapCut is the fact that Edits lets you export videos watermark-free. In comparison, you need to pay for CapCut Pro to export a video without a watermark.

As for the features themselves, the app’s “Ideas” tool allows you to jot down ideas for new videos, while the “Projects” feature helps you organize and manage different creations in one place. The “Inspirations” tool lets you browse through trending audio to create videos with audio you discover.

Edits’ “Green screen” feature lets you replace the background of your videos. Plus, the “Timeline” feature helps you arrange and adjust clips. You can also add automatic captions to your videos, along with music from Instagram’s library.

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In addition, you can turn static images into videos using AI thanks to the app's "Animate" feature. The app's "Cutouts" feature allows you to isolate specific objects with precision tracking.

Once you're happy with your video, you can share it directly to Instagram or Facebook from within the app. Or, you can choose to export the video to post it on other platforms.

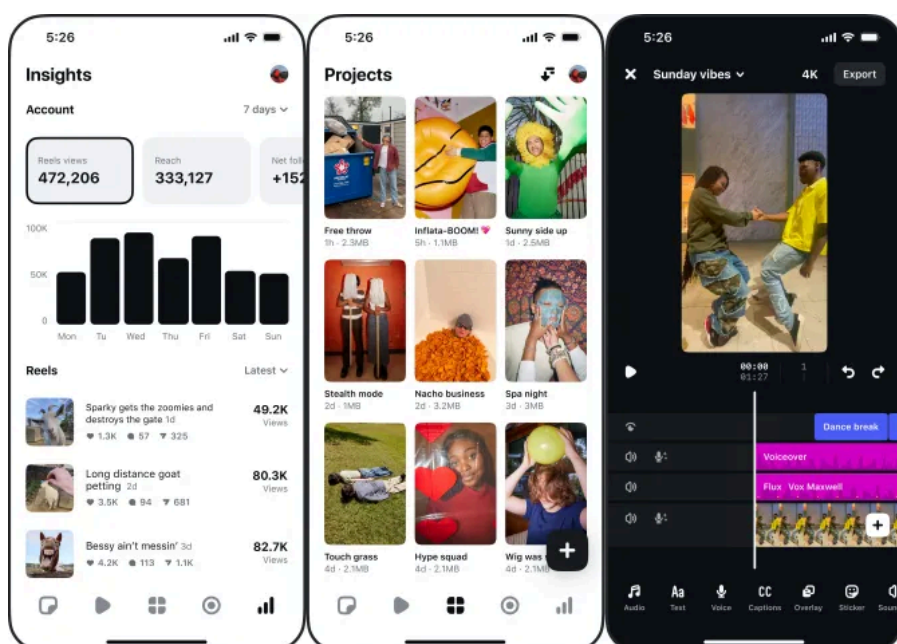


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Edits also features insights that can help you learn about your content strategy and factors that could impact your reach and distribution.

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Meta has teased a few new features that will be available on Edits in the future, including a “Modify” tool that will allow creators to use AI to alter the “look and feel” of their videos. Additionally, a “Keyframes” feature lets users pick specific moments to change the position, rotation, or size of their clips.

Plus, creators will soon be able to collaborate with other creators or brands to get feedback on their drafts. Meta also plans to release more fonts, text animations, transitions, voice effects, filters, sound effects, and music options in the future.

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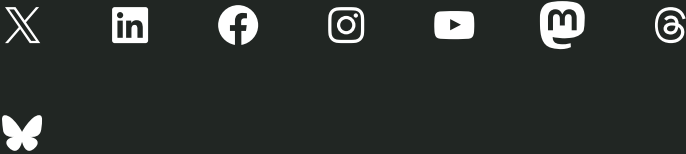
Aisha Malik

Consumer News Reporter | [X](#)

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